



Toshiba's new notebook beast

Toshiba recently launched their 500 GB, 7,200 rpm notebook 2.5-inch drive



Snow Leopard on the hunt

Snow Leopard outsells predecessors in opening weeks of availability

Laptop test

People who use Apple-based products are mainly designers and image-editing professionals who swear by the usability, interface and performance of these products. However, this doesn't mean someone wanting a regular notebook cannot buy a Macbook. There are a few people in office who use Macbooks and quite frankly they're as usable as a regular notebook. Obviously a few shortcut keys differ and the interface is unique, but the learning curve is relatively flat – Macbooks are designed to be pretty idiot-proof. An added advantage (and kudos to Apple for including this) is BootCamp – an addition to the Leopard OS that allows Windows XP to be installed in a dual boot.

The Macbook Air is unique at first glance. Designed to be really slim and sleek and lightweight the Macbook Air is built like a tank courtesy its all aluminium structure which is built out of

performance available. Whether it is the anaemic components or the lack of even a very basic RJ45 connect and a mediocre screen the Macbook Air will not impress anyone not looking for superficiality. And that's what it is – a superficial gem and priced at Rs. 1,12,000, it doesn't deliver as expected.

All the Macbook Pros look sleek as well, remember they come in three sizes – 13.3-inches, 15.4-inches and 17-inches. The all-aluminium body and the super slim profile means they just attract attention in any company. The 17-inch and 15-inch models are as slim as the



Apple Macbook Pro 13 inch

NVIDIA's GeForce 9400M integrated video solution that is acclaimed to be as powerful as many discrete graphics solutions. One of the only gripes with the Macbook Pro 13-inch in comparison to the others is the placement of the speakers – behind the notebook under the hinge as opposed to on either side of the keypad – this causes a decrease in sound volume and clarity. Apples segregated keypad is a little cumbersome at first, but amazing once you get the hang of using it. The keys are soft but not squishy and key feedback is decent. The adjustable backlighting is a little excessive but it gets the job done. When one sees the display quality, brightness and resolution on the 15-inch Macbook Pro the 13-inch doesn't look so hot anymore. The 15.4-inch model has a beautiful display that appears at least 15 per cent brighter and the resolution of



Apple Macbook Air

go against Apples design ethos but we're sure this can be improved. The second gripe is the gap between USB ports – it's too small and if you use a USB drive with a wide body the adjacent USB port becomes unusable – this is unforgivable

especially given that these notebooks have the space for four well spaced out ports. The Macbook Pro 17-inch is the only one with three ports while the others have two each. The 17 and 15.4-inch Macbook Pros have identical hardware but the 17-inch model has a higher screen resolution (1920 x 1200 pixels). The ability to switch between the integrated NVIDIA GeForce 9400M and the discrete GeForce 9600GT is a plus since you get more battery life with the former and greater performance with the latter.

In terms of performance none of the Macbook Pros are slouches and the two larger models have very powerful processors. Given an identical

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a single piece of aluminium, in fact this is something all the latest Macbooks share, therefore the term "unibody". The Air is compact enough to necessitate an external DVD RW drive and even the ports are minimal – no LAN port and a single USB port located on the under part of the body accessible by lifting a small hood-like cover. As sleek and sexy as the Air is and the fact that its storage subsystem is SSD based there's very little

13-inch Macbook Pro – this gives them the appearance of being even slimmer because of the larger screen size. The 13-inch Macbook Pro is little more than a 13-inch unibody Macbook released in 2008 with an SD slot and a permanent battery. That being said it's an exceptionally well-built and good-looking notebook. It has a great screen, much better than the display on the Macbook Air. It also sports pretty powerful components including

1440 x 900 pixels is ideal. The keypad layout and spacing is identical across all the models – a good thing.

We have two generic design gripes with Apple and this applies to all three Macbook Pros. One (and we hope you're listening Apple) the edge of the palmrest is sharp and this starts to hurt the wrists after 15 minutes of typing – sounds like we're nitpicking but this is, in fact, super annoying. Obviously a dull edge would

set of benchmarks we're sure these notebooks would be as fast or faster than most Windows based notebooks out there, but an apples to apples (pun!) comparison is just not possible between them. What we did notice was OS X seems to be better when it comes to hard drive usage and the Macbook Pros were faster in the file copy tests when compared to Windows notebooks.

If you're looking to buy an Apple based notebook we